

W.A.R H.A.M.S

WORLD ACCESS RETRIEVABLE HEAVY ASSAULT MODIFIABLE SUITES

THE BATTLE FOR PLANET X

Official Rulebook

*The corporations have spoken. The planet is rich. The orders are clear.
Deploy your H.A.M.S, seize every resource, and crush anyone who stands in your way.
There is no diplomacy — only Dominance.*

2–4 Players • Ages 14+ • 90–150 Minutes

Section 1 — Introduction

W.A.R H.A.M.S (World Access Retrievable Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — The Battle for Planet X is a sci-fi board game of corporate warfare, territorial control, and tactical betrayal for 2–4 players, ages 14+.

Each player commands a private military force — squads of heavily armed soldiers known as H.A.M.S (Heavy Assault Modifiable Suites) — deployed by a rival megacorporation to conquer a distant, resource-rich alien world. Victory belongs to the corporation that accumulates the most Dominance Points (DP) by seizing territory, harvesting resources, arming their squads with powerful Basic Armament Cards (BACs), and manipulating the battlefield through cunning Conspire Cards.

The planet has no name — not yet. At the start of each game, players collectively choose a name for their battleground. Use the following naming convention to generate an alien-sounding designation:

Suggested Planet Name Format: 2 consonants + vowel + 2 consonants + vowel, optionally followed by Roman numerals.
Examples: Nlendagru IV · Criftonba · Throskane II · Blentova IX This is just a suggestion — feel free to name your planet whatever you like!

Fight for resources. Fight for loyalty. Fight for the planet.

Detail	Value
Players	2–4
Ages	14+
Play Time	90–150 minutes

Section 2 — Components

Hex Tiles (61 total)

The planet surface is built from randomized hexagonal tiles. Each tile represents a region of terrain or a key strategic installation.

Hex Type	Border Color	Count	Description
Oil Rig	Black	3	Produces Oil (Oil Drum) resources
Power Plant	Yellow	3	Produces Electricity (Lightning Bolt) resources
Factory	Red	3	Produces Industry (Hammer) resources
Radar Dish	Blue	3	Produces Intelligence (Transmitting Wave) resources
City / Village	Green	3	Produces Local Favor (Recruit) resources
Separatist Base	Grey	3	Hostile NPC stronghold (printed numbers: 2, 4, 6)
Spaceport Drop Zone	Purple	6	Reinforcement landing sites (printed numbers: 1–6)
Terrain Hex	—	37	Open ground, forests, craters, etc.
		61	

Number Tokens (16 total)

Number Tokens are placed on resource-producing Hexes during setup to determine which Hexes produce resources on a given dice roll. Note: Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones have their numbers printed directly on the tile and do not use Number Tokens.

Number	Token Count
1	2
2	2
3	3
4	3
5	3
6	3
Total	16

Cards

Card Type	Total	Breakdown
BAC (Basic Armament Cards)	100	20 types × 5 copies
Conspire Cards	72	24 types × 3 copies

- BACs represent weapons, armor, gadgets, and upgrades equipped to your H.A.M.S.
- Conspire Cards represent political maneuvers, sabotage, intelligence operations, and tactical gambits.

Resource Tokens (5 types)

Resources are the lifeblood of your campaign. Each type is produced by its corresponding Hex.

Resource	Color	Depiction	Token	Token Colors
Oil	Black	Fuel	Oil Drum	Black on white, black border
Electricity	Yellow	Electricity Bolt	Lightning Bolt	Yellow on white, yellow border
Intelligence	Blue	Intel Operator Room	Transmitting Wave	Blue on white, blue border
Industry	Red	Industry Factory	Hammer	Red on white, red border
Local Favor	Green	Militia Base	Recruit	Green on white, green border

Dice

- 13 six-sided dice (d6) — used for combat, resource production, and event resolution.
- 1 Separatist Die (d6) — a distinct-colored d6 (grey) used as one of the 3 resource dice during Phase 1. Only this die triggers Separatist spawning.

Miniatures

Component	Details
H.A.M.S Miniatures	Soldier miniatures in 4 player colors — 28 per player (enough for 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each). Each mini has 5 magnetized attachment points for the equipment slots (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, Hands). Each soldier sits on a 40mm magnetized round base printed with a squad letter and soldier number (A1–A7, B1–B7, C1–C7, D1–D7) and bearing 3 blood-drop divots for damage tracking.
Equipment Modules	Physical miniature parts (helmets, chest plates, weapons, backpacks, leg armor) that magnetically attach to H.A.M.S minis. Each module corresponds to a BAC card type — e.g., a S.A.P (Standard Armor Plating) Helmet module, an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) rifle module. 8 copies of each module type exist (more than the 5 BAC cards per type, ensuring modules are available for re-equipping via the flag system). Each module has a unique sculpt per type and its abbreviation engraved on the underside for identification. When a BAC is equipped, its card is placed in the communal Equipment Display near the play area for all players to reference. The physical module on the mini is the source of truth for who has what equipped.
Separatist Miniatures	24 grey NPC soldiers — used for Separatist spawns, base defenders, and militia

Tokens & Accessories

Component	Description
Control Flags	25 small colored flag miniatures per player (one set per player color). Used to mark territorial control on hex tiles AND to mark equipped BAC types on the Equipment Display
Cargo Containers	12 numbered plastic containers 2*(1–6) placed on spaceport hexes when BACs arrive. Matching containers near the board form the Unloading Zone where BAC cards that landed on a specific space port are stored
Equipment Display	Shared area near the board where one copy of each BAC card is placed face-up as a reference. When a player equips a BAC type, place one of your Control Flags on that card to show your access. Multiple players' flags can be on the same card. Flags stay permanently — once placed, your flag is never removed, even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. It marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can re-equip it
Damage Pegs	Small red blood-drop pegs that snap into the divots on a soldier's base. Each base holds up to 3 pegs (4th wound = death).
Bunker Tokens	Neutral fortifications placed by D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System): +1 all defense dice on hex. 1 per hex max. Any unit benefits. Destroyed by attacker winning combat on the hex
Planet Frame	Circular board edge made of 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces that snap together to form the planet boundary. All 61 Hex tiles fill the entire interior.

Section 3 — Game Setup

Follow these steps in order to prepare the battlefield.

Step 1 — Assemble the Planet Frame

Snap the 5 interlocking cardboard puzzle pieces together to form the circular Planet Frame. Place it on the table — this defines the boundary of the playable surface. Note the connection points labeled along the edges (a, b, c, etc.) — hexes at opposite edges sharing the same letter are adjacent for movement and range (the planet wraps around).

Step 2 — Build the Planet

Shuffle all 61 Hex Tiles face-down. Place them randomly within the Planet Frame — tiles fill the entire interior of the circular board with no gaps. No peeking — the planet's geography is unknown until your forces make landfall.

Step 3 — Reveal the Surface

Flip all Hex Tiles face-up. The planet is revealed. Take a moment to survey the terrain — note where the resources, Spaceport Drop Zones, and Separatist Bases have appeared.

Step 4 — Place Number Tokens

Distribute the 16 Number Tokens across the 15 resource-producing Hexes (Oil Rigs, Power Plants, Factories, Radar Dishes, and Cities/Villages). Separatist Bases and Spaceport Drop Zones already have their numbers printed on the tile and do not receive Number Tokens.

Number	Tokens Available	Placement
1	2	Place on 2 resource Hexes
2	2	Place on 2 resource Hexes
3	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
4	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
5	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes
6	3	Place on 3 resource Hexes

Place them randomly. One Hex will receive two Number Tokens (since there are 16 tokens for 15 Hexes) — that Hex triggers on either number but still produces only 1 resource per roll (not double). This makes it a strategic hotspot that activates more often without snowballing resources.

Step 5 — Prepare the BAC Cards

Shuffle all 100 BAC Cards into a single face-down pile. Then:

1. Deal 3 BAC Cards face-down to each player. Players look at their cards but keep them secret.
2. Each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the remaining 2 cards face-down to the player on their left.
3. From the 2 cards received, each player chooses 1 card to keep and passes the last card to the left.
4. Each player keeps the final card received. All players now have a starting hand of 3 BAC Cards.
5. Place the remaining deck near the board — this is the Spaceport Deck.
6. Turn 6 cards face-up in a row beside the Spaceport Deck — this is the Planet Bound Area.

Always maintain 6 face-up cards in the Planet Bound Area. Whenever a card is taken from it, immediately replace it from the Spaceport Deck.

Step 6 — Prepare the Conspire Deck

Shuffle all 72 Conspire Cards and place them face-down near the board as the Conspire Deck. Do not deal any Conspire Cards during setup — they are only acquired during play.

Step 7 — Muster Your Forces

Each player takes the following in their chosen color:

- 10 H.A.M.S Miniatures (organized into 2 Squads of 5 soldiers each, e.g. A1–A5 and B1–B5)
- A pool of damage pegs kept beside the play area

Additional H.A.M.S are recruited during the game. You may eventually command up to 4 Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each (28 total).

Step 8 — Determine First Player

The oldest player takes the first turn. Play order proceeds clockwise from the first player.

Step 9 — Squad Placement (Snake Draft)

Players deploy their starting Squads to the planet surface using a snake draft. H.A.M.S drop from orbit — landing zones must be clear of hostile forces and away from critical infrastructure to avoid casualties and collateral damage.

Order	Action
Round 1	Starting with the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player places their 1st Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex (not resource hexes, Spaceports, or Separatist Bases).
Round 2	The last player in Round 1 immediately places their 2nd Squad on any unoccupied Terrain Hex. Then placement continues counter-clockwise, ending with the first player placing their 2nd Squad last.

Step 10 — Set Up the Unloading Zone

Place one set of 6 numbered Cargo Containers (1–6) in a row near the board — this is the Unloading Zone. Keep the second matching set of containers nearby.

When BAC cards arrive at spaceports during the game (via doubles/triples):

1. Place the BAC card face-up in the Unloading Zone under the container matching that spaceport's printed number. If BACs already exist in that slot, stack them face-up under the same container.
2. Place the matching container from the second set on the corresponding spaceport hex on the board to mark the delivery (if not already there).

Collecting BACs: During Phase 5, a Squad occupying a spaceport hex with a container marker may collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into their hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the Unloading Zone slot.

Step 11 — Stock the Supply

Set up a resource supply area beside the board. Sort all Resource Tokens by type into clearly separated piles so any player can easily access them.

Note — Every Planet Is Different! The random Hex placement during setup ensures that no two games of W.A.R H.A.M.S are alike. The geography of your planet, the location of critical resources, and the proximity of Separatist threats will change every session. Adapt your strategy — or be crushed.

TURN STRUCTURE

Starting from the first player and proceeding clockwise, each player completes all seven phases of their turn before play passes to the next player. No other player may act during your turn unless a Conspire Card, combat, or Phase 4 resource gathering (for combat participants) specifically requires it.

Phase 1: Resource Production

The active player rolls 2d6 + 1 Separatist Die (a grey d6). All three dice produce resources normally — for each unique number rolled, place 1 corresponding resource token on every hex tile bearing that number token. Duplicate dice do not produce extra resources — rolling the same number twice still produces only once for that number. This includes hexes currently occupied by Separatist forces.

Example: You roll 2, 4, and the Separatist Die shows 6. Every hex with a "2", "4", or "6" number token receives 1 resource token of its type. Example (Doubles): You roll 3, 3, and the Separatist Die shows 5. Every hex with a "3" token receives 1 resource token (not 2 — duplicates don't double production), and every hex with a "5" token receives 1 resource token. The doubled 3s also trigger a BAC delivery (see Doubles below).

Separatist Spawning — Only the Separatist Die (grey) triggers spawning. If the Separatist Die matches a Separatist Base's printed number (2, 4, or 6), spawn 3 Separatist miniatures at that base. They stay on the base — all Separatist movement, consumption, and combat is resolved later in Phase 7 by the active player (see Separatists section for full details). The other two dice never trigger spawns.

Doubles — If two of the three dice show the same number (e.g., 3, 3, 5):

- Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the doubled number (e.g., double 3s = the 3rd card in the row). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching that number, and place the matching numbered container on the spaceport hex with that printed number on the board. Multiple BAC cards may accumulate at a single Unloading Zone slot over successive turns.
- All unique numbers rolled still produce resources normally (the BAC delivery is an additional bonus, not a replacement).

Triples — If all three dice show the same number (e.g., 4, 4, 4):

- The active player chooses which spaceport drop zone on the board receives a BAC card. Take the BAC card from the Planet Bound Area whose position matches the tripled number (e.g., triple 4s = the 4th card). Place it face-up in the Unloading Zone container slot matching the chosen spaceport's printed number, and place the matching container on that spaceport hex.
- Additionally, the active player may move any single open (face-up) BAC from the Planet Bound Area to any Unloading Zone container slot of their choice.

Tip: Triples are rare but powerful — choosing which spaceport receives a BAC card lets you funnel valuable equipment toward your controlled zones or deny it to opponents.

Phase 2: Movement

The active player may move each of their Squads. Each individual H.A.M.S in a Squad may move up to 1 hex in any direction. A soldier equipped with Jump Jets (J.J) may move up to 2 hexes instead.

Soldiers within a Squad move independently — they are not required to stay grouped. Spreading out allows a Squad to cover more hexes for resource gathering, but isolated soldiers are vulnerable to attack. However, every soldier must remain within 2 hexes of at least one other squadmate at all times (squad coherency).

Exception — Jump Jets (J.J): A soldier equipped with J.J may move beyond squad coherency range, explicitly overriding the 2-hex rule. While disconnected (beyond 2 hexes of all squadmates), the soldier fights alone — rolling only their own dice with no squad support. They cannot benefit from Squad-level BAC effects (e.g., S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) crew, L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) spotting). The soldier may rejoin their Squad by moving back within 2 hexes of a squadmate on a later turn.

Example: A 5-soldier Squad on hex A could split: 2 soldiers stay on hex A, 1 moves to hex B, and 2 move to hex C. All five remain part of the same Squad — A is 2 hexes away from C, maintaining coherency.

Moving Through Separatists — A soldier may not move through a hex occupied by Separatist forces without engaging them in combat first (see Phase 3).

Board Wrapping — The planet is round. Hexes at the edges of the board connect to corresponding hexes on the opposite edge via marked connection points (labeled a, b, c, etc.). Movement and range calculations wrap accordingly.

Alternative: Conspire

Instead of moving a Squad, the active player may forfeit that Squad's movement to Conspire (see the full Conspiring section for details):

1. Draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck.
2. Keep 1 card and discard the other 2 face-down to the Conspire discard pile.
3. If a drawn card states otherwise (e.g., "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions instead.

A player may choose to move some Squads and Conspire with others — the choice is made per Squad. A Squad may also forfeit its Combat in Phase 3 to Conspire instead (see Phase 3).

Tip: Conspiring is your primary path to powerful one-time effects, resource conversion, and combat tricks. Don't neglect it — a well-timed Conspire Card can turn the tide of battle.

Claim Hexes (end of Phase 2)

After all of your Squads have finished moving, for every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it. Flags on hexes you do not currently occupy remain in place until an opponent later claims them by this same rule — the planet stays painted in your colour even after your Squad moves on.

Hexes containing both your soldiers AND an enemy's are contested — no flag is placed (or changed) at this step. Wait until Phase 3 Combat resolves who occupies the hex; the Claim Hexes step at the end of Phase 3 will then settle the flag.

Phase 3: Combat

If any enemy units — whether belonging to other players or Separatist forces — are within 2 hexes of the active player's soldiers, the active player may declare combat. Combat is never mandatory. Only engaged soldiers (within 2 hexes of the target) participate and roll dice.

To declare combat:

1. The active player states which of their Squads is attacking.
2. The active player designates which enemy Squad (or Separatist group) is the target.
3. Resolve combat according to the full Combat section below.

Multiple Combats — If the active player has multiple Squads engaged with different enemy forces, each may declare a separate combat. Resolve combats one at a time, in the order chosen by the active player.

Alternative: Conspire — Instead of declaring combat with a Squad, the active player may forfeit that Squad's attack to Conspire (draw 3 Conspire Cards, keep 1). The choice is made per Squad — some Squads may fight while others Conspire.

Note: Only the active player may initiate combat during this phase. Defending players respond as part of combat resolution but do not initiate attacks of their own.

Claim Hexes (end of Phase 3)

After all combats are resolved, re-run the Claim Hexes step exactly as in Phase 2: for every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place your Control Flag (return any opposing flag to its owner's supply). This catches the hexes that combat just cleared — for example, a hex you successfully attacked and pushed the defender off, or a contested hex where your soldiers survived and the opponent's didn't.

If a base was conquered this phase (all 7 base defenders killed), the conquering player places their flag on the base hex as part of this step.

Phase 4: Salvage & Resource Gathering

After all combats are resolved, the active player collects resources from the board. If combat occurred this turn, any defending player involved in that combat also collects resources during this phase.

Priority Order:

- If combat occurred: the combat winner picks first, then the loser. If neither side was clearly victorious (equal damage dealt), the active player picks first.
- If no combat occurred: only the active player collects.
- If multiple combats occurred, resolve collection per combat in the order chosen by the active player. A player involved in multiple combats still only collects once, using their best priority.

Quick Priority Reminder: \$` Combat winner -> \$a Combat loser -> \$b Active player (if no combat or tie). One collection per player.

Step 1 — Salvage Collection (if any):

Before collecting resources, any player whose soldier occupies a hex containing salvage modules (left behind after a death — see Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S, Step 4) may pick them up. Salvaged modules can be equipped for free — simply attach the module to the soldier's miniature. Salvage collection follows the same priority order listed above.

A player may choose to forfeit their salvage pickup and instead collect 1 resource token from the same hex during this step. This counts as their collection for the turn — they do not collect again in Step 2.

Step 2 — Resource Collection:

- Each soldier may pick up 1 resource token from the hex they currently occupy.
- A soldier equipped with B.E.A.R (Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover) may pick up 1 additional resource token of any type from the same hex.
- Continue in priority order until all accessible resources have been claimed or no player wishes to collect further.

Important: Resources cannot be collected from a hex occupied by Separatist units. Defeat them first.

Collected resource tokens go directly into the player's personal supply.

Note: Only the active player and players who participated in combat this turn may collect. Players not involved in combat wait for their own turn.

Phase 5: Purchase & Equip

The active player may unlock and equip BAC types, acquire new BAC cards, recruit soldiers, and create new Squads. All actions in this phase may be performed in any order and any number of times (resources permitting).

Equipping a BAC:

There are two ways to equip a BAC — unlocking a new type, or re-equipping a type you've already unlocked.

Unlocking a new BAC type:

1. Choose a BAC card from your hand and place it face-up in the Equipment Display (shared reference area near the board). If the card is already in the Display, discard your copy instead.
2. Place one of your Control Flags on that card in the Equipment Display — this marks that you have permanently unlocked this BAC type.
3. Pay the card's resource cost for each soldier you wish to equip.
4. Attach the matching equipment module (magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot (Head, Chest, Legs, Backpack, or Hands).

Equipping has no location requirement — you may equip any of your soldiers regardless of where they are on the board. Soldiers recruited this phase may also be equipped immediately.

Re-equipping an unlocked BAC type:

If your Control Flag is already on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, you may equip additional soldiers with that type at any time during Phase 5 — no card needed, just pay the resource cost per soldier and attach the module.

Limit: Only 8 copies of each equipment module exist in the game. If all 8 are currently in use, no more soldiers can equip that type until a module is freed (destroyed modules return to the box and can be purchased again).

Example: You have an H.C.A.R (Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle) card in hand. You place it in the Equipment Display and put your red flag on it — H.C.A.R is now unlocked for you permanently. You pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil per soldier and snap H.C.A.R rifle modules onto their Hands slot. Next turn, you recruit a new soldier and want to arm them too — just pay 1 Industry + 1 Oil again, no card needed.

Acquiring New BACs:

- Spaceport Deck Purchase: Spend 3 resource tokens of any single type while your Squad is at or adjacent to a Spaceport or City -> draw 1 face-down card from the Spaceport Deck into your hand.
- Spaceport Drop Zone Collection: If a Squad occupies a spaceport hex with a container marker, collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

Recruiting New Soldiers:

Pay 1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity while your Squad is in or adjacent to a City -> add 1 H.A.M.S to that Squad.

- Maximum 7 soldiers per Squad.

Creating New Squads:

Pay the soldier recruitment cost × the number of soldiers in the new Squad (minimum 5 soldiers to form a Squad).

- Maximum 4 Squads per player.
- The new Squad is placed at the City where it was recruited.

Example: Creating a new 5-soldier Squad costs $5 \times (1 \text{ Local Favor} + 1 \text{ Oil} + 1 \text{ Industry} + 1 \text{ Electricity}) = 5 \text{ Local Favor} + 5 \text{ Oil} + 5 \text{ Industry} + 5 \text{ Electricity}$.

Phase 6: Trade

The active player may trade resource tokens freely with any other player. Both parties must agree to the terms of the trade. There is no limit to the number of trades per turn.

- Only resource tokens may be traded. BAC cards, Conspire Cards, and equipment cannot be traded.
- All trades must be two-sided — both players must give and receive at least 1 resource token. No gifting or taking resources for free.
- Trades must be executed immediately — no promises of future payment or deferred trades are enforceable.
- Bank Trade: You may trade with the supply at a 3:1 ratio — return 3 of any single resource type to the supply and take 1 of any other type. No limit on bank trades per turn.

Example: Trading 1 Oil for 1 Electricity with another player is valid. Giving 1 Oil for nothing in return is not. If no one will trade, you can return 3 Oil to the supply and take 1 Electricity from the bank.

Phase 7: Move Separatists

All Separatist movement is resolved in four quick steps. The active player moves all Separatists on the board this phase (consume, move, combat) — there is no per-player territory split, which keeps the phase quick and unambiguous. All Separatists are processed, including any spawned during this turn's Phase 1 (or just now by Instigate Uprising) — spawning only places them on a base; the movement happens here.

Step 1 — Instigate Uprising

Any player who controls a conquered Separatist Base may pay 3 Local Favor to spawn 3 Separatists at any ONE unconquered base. They stay on that base — they will move in Step 3 below along with every other Separatist on the board. Once per round per conquered base you control (see Separatists — Instigate Uprising for full details).

Step 2 — Consume

Every Separatist sitting on a hex with resource tokens removes 1 token (return it to the supply). Resolve all Separatists simultaneously.

Step 3 — Move

Every Separatist moves up to 3 hexes this turn, resolved one at a time by the active player using a single priority rule:

1. Look within 3 hexes of the Separatist's current hex for any resource-producing hex (Oil / Power / Factory / Radar / City) that currently has 1 or more resource tokens on it.
2. If one or more such hexes exist: move the Separatist toward the hex with the most tokens. If multiple hexes are tied for most tokens, the active player chooses the destination.
3. If no producing hex within 3 hexes has any tokens: move the Separatist toward the nearest resource-producing hex (any of the 15 production tiles, even if empty). The Separatist still moves only up to 3 hexes per turn; if the target is farther, it continues advancing on later turns. If multiple producing hexes are tied for nearest, the active player chooses.

A Separatist already standing on its chosen target moves 0 (stays put). Movement is measured in hex-distance — each step into an adjacent hex counts as 1.

Move all Separatists before resolving any combat.

Step 4 — Resolve Combats

After all movement is complete, resolve combat on every hex where Separatists and player soldiers now share a space. The defending player fights normally; the player to their left rolls all Separatist dice (with the standard -1 penalty). Resolve each contested hex in clockwise order starting from the active player.

Tip: A producing hex with many tokens acts as a Separatist magnet — every Separatist within 3 hexes will converge on it. Clear high-token hexes near your soldiers to spread Separatists thin; let tokens pile up on hexes near opponents to draw the swarm there instead.

End of Turn

Once all seven phases are complete, play passes clockwise to the next player, who begins their turn at Phase 1.

End of Round

A round is one full cycle of all players' turns (each player completes Phases 1–7 once). After the last player in turn order finishes their turn, resolve the following before the next round begins:

- Any uncollected resource tokens remaining on hexes you control (marked with your Control Flag) are added to your personal supply.
- Any spaceport hexes you control that have a container marker on them: collect all BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot into your hand. Remove the container from the board hex and reset the slot.

Then a new round begins with the first player.

Turn Summary — Quick Reference

Phase	Name	Summary
1	Resource Production	Roll 3d6, spawn resources on matching hexes. Doubles/triples = BAC drops at spaceports
2	Movement	Move each soldier up to 1 hex (2 with J.J). Alternatively, Conspire instead of moving a Squad
3	Combat	Declare attacks against enemies within 2 hexes. Only engaged soldiers (within 2 hexes of target) roll dice
4	Salvage & Resource Gathering	Salvage modules from current hex first, then collect resource tokens. Priority: winner -> loser -> active player (if no combat)
5	Purchase & Equip	Spend resource tokens to buy and equip BACs, recruit soldiers, or create new Squads
6	Trade	Trade resource tokens freely with other players by mutual agreement
7	Move Separatists	Uprising -> consume -> 1 roll moves all Separatists -> resolve combats

COMBAT SYSTEM

Steel meets steel. Dice hit the table. Only one side walks away whole.

Combat is the heart of W.A.R H.A.M.S. When corporations clash over hexes, resources, and dominance, the battlefield is decided through a structured sequence of dice rolls, tactical assignments, equipment bonuses, and card play.

Initiating Combat

During Phase 3 of the active player's turn, they may declare an attack with any of their Squads against an enemy Squad (or Separatist group). Player-vs-player combat is never mandatory — you always choose whether to attack. Separatist combat in Phase 7 is mandatory (see Fighting Separatists).

- Each Squad may declare one attack per turn.
- To initiate combat, at least one of the attacking Squad's soldiers must be within 2 hexes of at least one soldier in the target Squad.
- Engaged soldiers only: Only soldiers within 2 hexes of at least one enemy soldier in the target Squad participate in combat and roll dice. Soldiers outside this range sit out — they do not roll attack or defense dice.
- S.L.I.M.E (mortar) has extended range and may fire from beyond 2 hexes (up to 3 hexes). Mortar crew count as engaged even if outside normal range. B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) fires at up to 2 hexes in a pre-combat step — within normal engagement range, but its range can be extended via L.P.M (Laser Pointer Module) (up to 4 hexes). See Special Weapon Rules below.
- Only the active player may initiate combat. Defenders respond during combat resolution but do not choose to attack on another player's turn.

Combat Resolution — Step by Step

Once combat is declared, resolve it by following Steps 1 through 6 in order.

Step 1: Roll Attack & Defense Dice

Both players roll simultaneously.

- Attacker rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the attacking Squad (only soldiers within 2 hexes of the enemy, plus any with extended-range weapons).
- Defender rolls 1d6 for each engaged H.A.M.S in the defending Squad.

Dice Advantage Rule

When one side has more soldiers than the other, the side with more soldiers still rolls dice equal to their full soldier count. However, only a number of dice equal to the smaller Squad's size are used in matchups. The player with more dice selects their best dice (highest values) to assign.

The extra dice provide more options — not more attacks or defenses. The number of matchups is always equal to the smaller Squad's soldier count.

Worked Example — Attacker Outnumbers Defender: A 5-soldier Squad attacks a 3-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 3 dice: 4, 4, 2 - The smaller Squad has 3 soldiers, so there are 3 matchups. - Attacker picks their best 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender must use all 3 of their dice: 4, 4, 2 - Attacker assigns matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — all three defenders are hit!

Worked Example — Defender Outnumbers Attacker: A 3-soldier Squad attacks a 5-soldier Squad. - Attacker rolls 3 dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender rolls 5 dice: 1, 1, 4, 4, 2 - There are 3 matchups (equal to the smaller Squad). - Attacker must use all 3 of their dice: 5, 5, 6 - Defender picks their best 3 from 5 dice: 4, 4, 2 - Matchups: 6->4, 5->4, 5->2 — still hits, but the defender had more choices to select their strongest defense dice.

Step 2: Assign Dice (Attacker Chooses Matchups)

After both sides have selected their dice, the Attacker assigns matchups. This is one of the most tactically important moments in combat.

1. The Attacker places each of their selected attack dice in front of a specific defending H.A.M.S miniature. Each defending soldier receives exactly one attack die.
2. The Defender then assigns their defense dice, placing one defense die next to each attack die.

Each matchup is now a one-on-one comparison:

Comparison	Result
Attack die > Defense die	HIT — the difference equals damage dealt
Attack die <= Defense die	BLOCKED — no damage is dealt

Worked Example — Dice Assignment: Attacker rolls: 6, 4, 1 — Defender rolls: 5, 4, 6 The Attacker assigns:

Target	Attack Die	Defense Die	Result
Soldier A	6	5	HIT (6 - 5 = 1 damage)
Soldier B	4	4	BLOCKED (tie goes to defender)
Soldier C	1	6	BLOCKED (defense wins)

Total: 1 hit dealing 1 damage peg to Soldier A. Note: The Attacker chose to throw their 6 at Soldier A. A different assignment would have changed the outcome entirely. Choose your matchups wisely.

Step 3: Apply Equipment Bonuses

After initial dice placement, both sides apply bonuses from equipped BAC cards. Bonuses modify the face value of dice already placed — they do not add additional dice.

1. Attacker applies attack bonuses first (e.g., H.C.A.R grants +1 attack to the equipped soldier's die).
2. Defender applies defense bonuses second (e.g., S.A.P armor grants +1 defense to the equipped soldier's die).

Equipment bonuses can change the outcome of matchups that were previously hits or blocks.

Worked Example — Equipment Bonuses: From the previous example, Soldier A was hit: Attack 6 vs Defense 5 = 1 damage. But Soldier A is equipped with S.A.P armor (+1 defense). The defense die increases from 5 to 6.

Target	Attack Die	Defense Die (after bonus)	Result
Soldier A	6	5 + 1 = 6	BLOCKED! S.A.P armor saves Soldier A.

Conversely: if the Attacker had a H.C.A.R-equipped soldier (+1 attack), the attack die would have been 7 vs 6 — a hit for 1 damage, punching through the armor.

Step 4: Play Conspire Cards

After equipment bonuses are applied, both players may play Combat Conspire Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier) to alter the outcome.

Order of play:

1. Defender plays Combat Conspire Cards first.
2. Attacker responds with their own Combat Conspire Cards second.

Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards. Tactical Conspire Cards cannot be played during this step.

Example Conspire Card	Effect
Guerrilla Warfare	Add 1d6 to your attack total
Defender Instant Shield	Add 1d6 to your defense total
Old School RPG	Grant +1 attack to one soldier's die
One Pulse Barrier	Grant +1 defense to one soldier's die

Tip: The Defender plays first — the Attacker always gets the last word. A shrewd Attacker can wait to see the Defender's cards before deciding whether to spend their own.

Step 5: Resolve Damage

After all dice modifications and card effects are applied, calculate final damage for every matchup.

For each HIT (attack die > defense die):

- The difference between the final attack value and the final defense value equals the number of damage pegs inserted into the divots on that defending H.A.M.S.'s base.
- Each base has 3 blood-drop divots. Insert one red peg per point of damage taken.
- Damage persists between turns. A wounded H.A.M.S. keeps its pegs until healed by a card effect or ability (which removes pegs from the divots).

Combat Winner

The player who inflicted more total damage across all matchups in this combat is the combat winner.

Death Threshold

A H.A.M.S. can sustain a maximum of 3 damage pegs. When a soldier would receive a 4th damage peg, that soldier dies.

Worked Example: Soldier A already carries 2 damage pegs from a previous turn. In this combat, Soldier A's matchup results in a HIT dealing 2 damage. Soldier A now has $2 + 2 = 4$ damage pegs -> Soldier A is killed.

Step 6: Counterattack

After all damage is resolved, check every defender's matchup for a potential Counterattack.

Counterattack Trigger: Any defending soldier whose defense die beat the attack die by 3 or more earns a Counterattack.

Defender	Attack Die	Defense Die	Difference	Result
Soldier A	6	5	-1 (attacker won)	No counterattack
Soldier B	4	4	+0 for defender	No counterattack (difference < 3)
Soldier C	1	6	+5 for defender	COUNTERATTACK triggered

When a Counterattack is triggered:

1. The counterattacking defender becomes the Attacker in a new mini-combat round.
2. All normal combat rules apply (Steps 1–6), using only the counterattacking soldier(s) and the original attacker's soldiers they were matched against.
3. Counterattacks can chain — but each successive counterattack suffers a cumulative -1 Combat Fatigue penalty to all dice rolls. The 1st counterattack has no penalty, the 2nd has -1, the 3rd has -2, etc. This makes extended chains increasingly unlikely to trigger.

Worked Example — Counterattack: Continuing from the earlier combat: The Attacker assigned a 1 against Soldier C's defense of 6. Difference: $6 - 1 = 5$ (≥ 3) — Counterattack triggered! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 1 — no fatigue penalty): Soldier C is now the Attacker. Both sides roll 1d6:

Matchup	Attack Die	Defense Die	Result
Soldier C vs Original Attacker	2	5	BLOCKED (defense wins by 3)

The original attacker's defense die (5) beat the attack die (2) by 3 — exactly the threshold. Another Counterattack triggers! Mini-Combat Round (Chain 2 — Combat Fatigue: -1 to all dice): The original attacker strikes back. Both roll 1d6, but subtract 1 from each roll (minimum 1):

Matchup	Raw Roll	Fatigue	Final Die	Result
Original Attacker (attack)	4	-1	3	
Soldier C (defense)	3	-1	2	
Result			3 vs 2	HIT (1 damage)

Difference is only 1 — no further counterattack. The chain ends.

Death in W.A.R H.A.M.S

When a H.A.M.S accumulates 4 or more damage pegs, the soldier is killed. Resolve immediately:

1. Lethal Hit Roll

The owning player rolls 1d6 to determine where the killing blow struck:

Roll	Slot Hit
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4–5	Chest
6	Hands (weapon)

2. Module Destroyed

Detach the equipment module from the struck slot and return it to the box (it becomes available for purchase again). If the struck slot is empty (no module equipped), no module is destroyed — proceed directly to salvage distribution.

3. Salvage Distribution

Pick Order	Player	Action
1st	Owner (dead soldier's player)	Choose 1 remaining equipped module to keep — may immediately attach it to another existing soldier in the same Squad for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency
2nd	Attacker (killing player)	Choose 1 remaining equipped module to take — may immediately attach it to one of their soldiers for free, provided that soldier is not outside of coherency
3rd	—	All remaining modules are left on the hex as salvage

4. Salvage

Modules left on the hex may be picked up by any soldier occupying that hex during Phase 4: Salvage & Resource Gathering, Step 1 (Salvage Collection). Salvage collection happens before regular resource gathering. Salvaged modules can be equipped for free (the cost was already paid) — simply attach the module to the soldier's mini. Check the Equipment Display to confirm the module's identity and effect.

5. Coherency Check

After a death, check if any surviving squadmates are now beyond 2 hexes from all other squadmates. If so, those soldiers are disconnected — they fight alone (own dice only, no Squad-level BAC effects), identical to the J.J disconnection rules. Disconnected soldiers suffer a -1 penalty to all dice rolls (minimum 1) and must use their next Movement phase to move back within 2 hexes of a squadmate. Until they rejoin, they cannot benefit from effects like S.L.I.M.E crew, L.P.M spotting, or other Squad-level abilities.

Civilian Damage Rule

When using area-of-effect weaponry — specifically S.L.I.M.E (mortar) or other artillery — on a hex that produces Local Favor (City or Village):

- All opposing players each gain 2 Local Favor resource tokens immediately.
- The attacking player loses ALL of their current Local Favor tokens.

Bombarding cities wins battles but loses hearts and minds.

Separatist Combat

Separatist Rule	Detail
Rolled By	The player to the left of the player fighting the Separatists rolls all Separatist dice
Dice Penalty	Roaming Separatists roll with -1 to all dice (minimum result of 1)
Fragile	Each Separatist has only 1 life — any hit kills them instantly
Blocking Movement	A soldier may not move through or collect resources from a hex occupied by Separatists without defeating them first
Conquering a Base	The base spawns 7 Separatists when first engaged. All 7 must be defeated to conquer. Base defenders roll full d6 (no -1 penalty) — they are dug in and fight at full strength

Special Weapon Rules

B.A.S.R (Bolt Action Sniper Rifle) — Sniper Rifle

One shot. One kill. Before anyone else fires.

Property	Value
Timing	Fires before normal combat (pre-combat step)
Dice	Roll 2d6, pick the higher result
Target	1 specific soldier up to 2 hexes away. Target defends normally (1d6)
Restriction	Sniper does not participate in normal combat
Vulnerability	While defending: both the sniper and the target get -1 to defense die

S.L.I.M.E (Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment) — Mortar

Rain fire from a distance.

Property	Value
Crew	Requires 2 soldiers
Dice	Roll 4d6
Target	An entire enemy Squad up to 3 hexes away
Restriction	Mortar crew skips normal combat
Vulnerability	-1 defense when attacked directly
Civilian Damage	Targeting a City/Village hex triggers the Civilian Damage Rule: all opposing players gain 2 Local Favor; attacker loses all Local Favor (see §Civilian Damage Rule)

L.P.M (Laser Pointer Marker) — Laser Pointer Module

Paint the target. Let the heavy weapons do the rest.

Property	Value
Function	Extends B.A.S.R and S.L.I.M.E effective range
Mechanic	Weapons may target enemies adjacent to the L.P.M carrier
Maximum Range	4 hexes total
Restriction	L.P.M carrier does not fire — they designate targets

Bunker Rules

Bunker tokens are placed by the D.U.D.S (Deployable Unital Defense System) equipment module. Once deployed, a bunker becomes a permanent terrain feature on the hex.

Rule	Detail
Placement	Activate D.U.D.S to place a bunker token on the hex the soldier occupies. D.U.D.S module is removed from the soldier (one-use), freeing the backpack slot
Effect	+1 to all defense dice for any unit defending on this hex
Ownership	Bunkers are neutral fortifications — any unit on the hex benefits, regardless of faction
Stacking	1 bunker per hex maximum
Persistence	Bunker tokens remain on the hex until destroyed
Destruction	An attacker who wins combat on a bunkered hex may choose to destroy the bunker (remove the token) instead of claiming the hex
Bunker DP	Deployer earns 2 DP permanently upon deployment. Whoever controls the bunkered hex earns an additional 2 DP (total 4 DP for deployer holding their own bunker)

Tip: Bunkers alter the terrain permanently — place them on chokepoints you plan to hold, but beware: if you lose the hex, your enemies dig in behind your own fortifications.

Combat Quick Reference

Step	Action	Who Acts
Pre-Combat	Resolve B.A.S.R (sniper) and S.L.I.M.E (mortar) attacks	Attacker
Step 1	Roll attack & defense dice (1d6 per soldier)	Both
Step 2	Attacker assigns matchups; Defender assigns defense dice	Both
Step 3	Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)	Both
Step 4	Play Conspire Cards (Defender first, then Attacker)	Both
Step 5	Resolve damage (attack - defense = damage pegs)	—
Step 6	Check for Counterattacks (defense beat attack by 3+)	Defender

Key Thresholds:

Threshold	Value
Damage pegs to kill a H.A.M.S	4 (dies on the 4th peg)
Counterattack trigger	Defense beats attack by 3 or more (chains get -1 cumulative fatigue)
Separatist lives	1 (dies on any hit)
Separatist dice penalty	-1 to all rolls (roaming only; base defenders roll full d6)

BASIC ARMAMENT CARDS (BACs)

BACs are the weapons, armor, gadgets, and tactical systems that transform your H.A.M.S from expendable grunts into an unstoppable force.

Card Anatomy

Zone	Location	Description
Name	Top center	The BAC's full military acronym designation
Cost	Top right	Resource cost per soldier equipped
Slot	Bottom left	Equipment slot: Head, Backpack, Legs, Chest, or Hands
DP Value	Bottom right	Dominance Points this card contributes while equipped
Card Text	Center	The BAC's mechanical effect

Equipment Slots

Each soldier has 5 equipment slots, determined by die roll when a slot is targeted:

Die Roll	Slot
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4-5	Chest
6	Hands

Each soldier may carry 1 module per slot. A Squad may equip multiple BAC types, but no individual soldier may double up on a single slot.

Module Identification & the Equipment Display

Every equipment module has a unique sculpt — an H.C.A.R rifle looks different from a B.A.S.R sniper, a S.A.P Helmet looks different from a S.H.A.D (Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone) helmet. Each module also has its abbreviation engraved on the underside for confirmation.

When a BAC type is equipped for the first time in the game, place its BAC card face-up in the Equipment Display — a shared area near the board visible to all players. Place one reference module on top of the card so everyone can see what that module looks like.

The Equipment Display serves as the communal reference for all active equipment in the game:

What you need to know	Where to look
What does this module do?	Equipment Display — read the BAC card
What is this module's DP value?	Equipment Display — check the card
Which soldiers have this module?	Look at the minis — the sculpt matches the reference module
Who owns which modules?	The modules physically attached to each player's colored minis

The modules on the minis are the source of truth — not cards, not boards. If a module is on your soldier, you have it. If it's not, you don't.

Tip: Any player can pick up a module from the board and compare its sculpt to the reference modules in the Equipment Display to identify it.

Equipping Rules

- Choose a BAC card from your hand and pay the listed resource cost per soldier you wish to equip.
- If this BAC type is not yet in the Equipment Display, place the card face-up there and place one of your Control Flags on it to mark it as permanently unlocked. If it's already in the Equipment Display, discard the card and place your flag on the existing card.
- Attach the matching equipment module (physical magnetized part) to each equipped soldier's miniature in the correct slot.
- Modules = Truth: The physical modules on minis are the definitive record of who has what. The Equipment Display is for reference only.
- Flags are permanent: Once your Control Flag is placed on a BAC card in the Equipment Display, it stays for the rest of the game — even if all your soldiers carrying that module die. Your flag marks that you've unlocked that BAC type and can pay to equip it again.
- Exception — T.I.L.T.S (Tactical Ion Team Link Shield): Pay the listed cost per soldier as normal. During combat, two adjacent T.I.L.T.S soldiers may swap one attacker's assigned die between them. This ability is always active — no tapping required. No other backpack module may be equipped alongside T.I.L.T.S.
- S.A.P -> C.A.P Upgrade: Custom Armor Plating (C.A.P) requires trading in the corresponding S.A.P piece as part of the upgrade cost. Detach the S.A.P module from the mini and return it to the supply, then attach the C.A.P module.
- Armor Stacking: S.A.P and C.A.P pieces each grant their defense bonus independently (+1 per S.A.P piece, +2 per C.A.P piece). There are no set bonuses — equip as many or as few armor pieces as your strategy demands.
- Tapping: Some modules are Tapped (rotated 90° on the mini or marked with a tap token) when activated. A Tapped module cannot be used again until Untapped (recharged) — typically at a City or Spaceport for a resource cost.
- One-Shot: Modules marked as one-use (e.g., D.U.D.S) are removed from the soldier after activation, freeing the slot. The module is returned to the supply and no longer counts toward DP.

Activating Modules

Modules with active abilities fall into two timing categories:

Category	When to Activate	Examples
Combat Modules	During combat resolution at Step 3 (equipment bonuses)	N.I.N.J.A (Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid; +3 defense die)
Field Modules	During Phase 5 (Purchase & Equip) on your turn	P.L.A.S.T.E.R (Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot; heal damage), D.U.D.S (place bunker)

- Untapping (recharging) a Tapped module is also done during Phase 5. The soldier must be at the required location (City or Spaceport) and you must pay the listed recharge cost.
- Passive bonuses (e.g., H.C.A.R +1 attack, S.A.P +1 defense) are always active and require no activation — they apply automatically during combat.

Full BAC Card List (20 Types × 5 Copies = 100 Cards)

Category	Abbr	Full Name	Slot	Cost	DP	Effect
Armor	S.A.P Chest	Standard Armor Plating Chest Piece	Chest	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
	S.A.P Helmet	Standard Armor Plating Helmet	Head	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
	S.A.P Legs	Standard Armor Plating Legs	Legs	1 Oil, 1 Industry	1	This soldier gets +1 to its defense die
	C.A.P Chest	Custom Armor Plating Chest	Chest	1 S.A.P Chest + 1 LF, 1 Ind, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
	C.A.P Head	Custom Armor Plating Helmet	Head	1 S.A.P Head + 1 LF, 1 Int, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
	C.A.P Legs	Custom Armor Plating Legs	Legs	1 S.A.P Legs + 1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Oil	4	This soldier gets +2 to its defense die
Weapons	H.C.A.R	Heavy Caliber Assault Rifle	Hands	1 Ind, 1 Oil	2	+1 attack die
	R.S.G	Repeating Shotgun	Hands	1 Oil, 1 LF	2	Within 1 hex: +2 attack. Beyond 1 hex: -1 attack
	P.C.S.M.G	Projectile Correcting Sub Machine Gun	Hands	1 Elec, 1 Ind, 1 Int	3	Within 1 hex: roll 3d6 pick highest
Heavy	B.A.S.R	Bolt Action Sniper Rifle	Hands	1 Oil, 1 Int, 1 Ind	4	Pre-combat: 2d6 pick higher, target 1 soldier up to 2 hexes. Sniper skips combat. Both get -1 defense
	S.L.I.M.E	Squad Light Interoperable Mortar Encampment	Backpack	1 Ind, 2 Oil, 2 LF	5	2-soldier crew. 4d6 normal matchups, target squad up to 3 hexes. Crew skips combat. -1 defense. Civilian Damage Rule
Support	P.L.A.S.T.E.R	Personal Lasting Aid Surgical Treatment Enhancement Robot	Chest	1 Elec, 1 LF	2	Heal up to 2 damage on any soldier same hex. Tap. Recharge: 1 Elec
	B.E.A.R	Battlefield Extraction Airlift Rover	Chest	1 Oil, 1 Ind, 1 Elec	3	+1 extra resource from same hex during Phase 4
	L.P.M	Laser Pointer Marker	Backpack	1 Elec, 1 LF, 1 Int	4	B.A.S.R/S.L.I.M.E target enemies near L.P.M carrier. Max 4 hex
	D.U.D.S	Deployable Unital Defense System	Backpack	1 LF, 1 Oil, 1 Ind	2	Place bunker: +1 all defense dice. One-use, frees slot. 2 DP deploy + 2 DP to hex controller
Tech	J.J	Jump Jets	Legs	1 Ind, 1 Int	2	Move 2 hexes. May override coherency (fights alone)
	S.H.A.D	Sensory Helmet, Advisory Drone	Head	2 Int, 1 Elec	5	Attacker must reveal Conspire cards before combat
	P.A.E.H	Personal Accuracy Enhancement Helmet	Head	1 LF, 1 Elec, 1 Int	4	+1 attack die while also equipped with H.C.A.R
	N.I.N.J.A	Nir Ion Nullifier Jammer Aid	Legs	1 Int, 1 Elec	2	+3 to one defense die. Tap. Recharge: 2 Elec
	T.I.L.T.S	Tactical Ion Team Link Shield	Backpack	1 Elec, 1 Ind, 2 Int	5	Adjacent T.I.L.T.S pair swap one attacker die. Always active. No other backpack

CONSPIRING

A player may forfeit a Squad's Movement (Phase 2) OR Combat (Phase 3) to Conspire. The choice is made per Squad — some Squads may move and fight normally while others Conspire.

Drawing Conspire Cards

1. Draw 3 cards from the Conspire Deck.
 2. Keep 1 card, discard the other 2 face-down.
 3. If a drawn card states otherwise (e.g., "keep 2"), follow that card's instructions.
- A single Squad may Conspire in both Phase 2 and Phase 3 of the same turn (forfeiting both movement and combat), drawing twice.

Hand Limit: A player may hold a maximum of 7 Conspire Cards. At the end of your turn, if you have more than 7, discard down to 7 (your choice which to discard).

Playing Conspire Cards

- Conspire Cards fall into two timing categories:
- Combat Cards (Guerrilla Warfare, Defender Instant Shield, Old School RPG, One Pulse Barrier):**
- Played only during combat at Step 4 of combat resolution.
 - Defender plays first, then Attacker responds.
 - Each player may play any number of eligible Combat Conspire Cards.
- Tactical Cards (all other Conspire Cards — resource exchange, free resource, territory control, etc.):**
- May be played at any time — during your turn, another player's turn, or between phases.
 - Effects resolve instantly.
- Pay any listed cost when you play the card.

Deck Exhaustion

When the Conspire Deck is empty, shuffle the discard pile to form a new deck.

Full Conspire Card List (24 Types × 3 Copies = 72 Cards)

Resource Exchange (1 Cost -> 3 Gain)

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Abandoned Satellite Control Station	1 Electricity	Exchange for 3 Intelligence	3
Build a Wind Farm	1 Industry	Exchange for 3 Electricity	3
Raid an Oil Cache	1 Intelligence	Exchange for 3 Oil	3
Factory Takeover	1 Local Favor	Exchange for 3 Industry	3
Build a Follower Camp	1 Industry	Exchange for 3 Local Favor	3

Free Resource (Gain 1, Chance for Bonus)

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Recruit Eager Volunteers	Free	Gain 1 Local Favor. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Scout Ahead	Free	Gain 1 Intelligence. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Tap into Oil Reserves	Free	Gain 1 Oil. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Proper Planning	Free	Gain 1 Industry. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3
Tap into the Local Power Grid	Free	Gain 1 Electricity. Roll d6: on 5–6, gain 1 additional resource token of any type you choose	3

Combat

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Guerrilla Warfare	1 Local Favor	Add 1d6 to an attack combat roll	3
Defender Instant Shield	1 Oil	Add 1d6 to a defense combat roll	3
Old School RPG	Free	+1 to an attack combat roll	3
One Pulse Barrier	Free	+1 to a defense combat roll	3

Tactical

Name	Cost	Effect	Copies
Deal with Local Militia	3 Local Favor	Spawn 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of your soldier. They immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad, then are removed (see Militia Rules below)	3
A Rough Night	1 Local Favor, 2 Intelligence	Target any Squad: immobilized AND -1 combat rolls next turn	3
Traveling Med Bay	X resources (X <= 3)	Exchange any 1 resource to heal 1 damage peg. Repeat up to 3×	3
Deal with a Local Representative	1 any resource	Conspire again, keep 2 cards instead of 1	3
Hack a PortNet Relay	1 Intelligence	Take 1 face-up BAC from the Planet Bound Area into your hand. Immediately refill the empty slot from the Spaceport Deck	3

Territory Control (Require Controlling 2+ of a Resource Type)

Name	Condition	Effect	Copies
Knowledge is Power	Control 2+ Intelligence tiles	Gain 2 BACs from Spaceport Deck	3
Civilian Goods Transport	Control 2+ Local Favor tiles	Gain any 4 resource tokens	3
Black Gold Syndicate	Control 2+ Oil tiles	Draw 2 Conspire cards (keep both)	3
At the Cover of Darkness	Control 2+ Electricity tiles	Steal from opponent: 2 resources, OR 1 Conspire, OR 1 BAC	3
Factory Cost Savings	Control 2+ Industry tiles	Equip a BAC free for 2 soldiers. Pay normal cost for rest	3

SEPARATISTS

Separatists are rogue fighting forces loyal to no corporation — remnants of failed colonial garrisons, opportunistic raiders, and alien sympathizers who resist all outside control.

Spawning

When a number matching a Separatist Base's printed number is rolled during Phase 1, spawn 3 grey Separatist miniatures on that base. The three bases are numbered 2, 4, and 6 (printed on the tile). Spawned Separatists stay on the base. All Separatist movement, consumption, and combat is resolved later in Phase 7 (see Behavior below). If insufficient Separatist miniatures remain in the supply, spawn as many as possible. Excess spawns are lost.

Behavior (Phase 7)

The active player moves all Separatists during this phase — consume, move, and combat steps are all resolved by the active player, regardless of whose territory the Separatists are in.

1. Consume — Every Separatist on a hex with tokens removes 1 token (all at once).
2. Move — Every Separatist moves up to 3 hexes toward the producing hex with the most tokens within 3 hexes; ties broken by the active player. If no producing hex within 3 hexes has tokens, head for the nearest producing hex (ties broken by the active player), still capped at 3 hexes per turn.
3. Combat — Resolve each hex where Separatists and soldiers share space. Player to the left of the defender rolls Separatist dice.

Fighting Separatists

Rule	Detail
Dice Penalty	Roaming Separatists: -1 to all dice. Base defenders roll full d6 (no -1 penalty)
Hit Points	1 life — any hit kills instantly
Mandatory	Must fight before collecting resources or moving through

Conquering Bases

- Attack triggers 7 defenders at the base. Base defenders roll full d6 (no -1 penalty) — they are dug in and fight at full strength.
- Once all 7 are defeated, place your Control Flag.
- Conquered bases stop spawning naturally (their printed number no longer triggers spawns).
- Once ALL 3 bases are captured: bases produce 1 Local Favor when their number is rolled.

Warning: Don't attack a base unless you can handle all 7 defenders! Survivors scatter toward resource hexes.

Instigate Uprising (Conquered Base Ability)

During Phase 7 Step 1, the controller of a conquered base may pay 3 Local Favor to spawn 3 Separatists at any ONE other unconquered Separatist Base. The spawned Separatists stay on that base — they will move in Step 3 of this same Phase 7, alongside every other Separatist on the board (see Phase 7 movement rules).

Rule	Detail
Timing	Phase 7 (Separatist Phase), before normal Separatist behavior
Cost	3 Local Favor
Target	Any unconquered Separatist Base
Limit	Once per round, per conquered base you control
Effect	Spawn 3 Separatists at target base; they move later in Step 3 of this same Phase 7

Tip: Instigate Uprising lets you weaponize conquered bases — direct Separatist pressure toward opponents' resource hexes while you profit from stability.

MILITIA

Militia are temporary local fighters summoned by the Deal with Local Militia Conspire Card. They are not a permanent force — they attack once and disperse.

Rule	Detail
Spawning	Place 3 militia on a hex within 2 hexes of one of your soldiers. Spawning is mandatory — the card effect cannot be partially resolved
Components	Use spare Separatist miniatures. If none are available, use any substitute (coins, tokens, dice, etc.)
Combat	Militia immediately attack one adjacent enemy Squad using normal combat rules
Dice Penalty	-1 to all dice (same as Separatists)
Hit Points	1 life each — any hit kills instantly
No Equipment	Militia carry no BACs and have no equipment slots
Dispersal	All militia are removed from the board after their attack resolves, regardless of outcome

Note: Militia act on the summoning player's behalf — the summoning player assigns their attack dice and chooses matchups.

CONTROLLING TERRITORY

Claiming a Hex

Claim is resolved automatically at the end of Phase 2 (Movement) and again at the end of Phase 3 (Combat) — see the Claim Hexes sub-steps in each phase. The rule in both places:

For every hex containing one or more of your soldiers and no enemy soldiers, place one of your Control Flags on that hex. If an opposing flag is already there, return it to that opponent's supply and replace it with yours. If your own flag is already there, leave it.

This applies to resource-producing hexes, Spaceport Drop Zones, Separatist Bases (once conquered — all 7 defenders killed), and Terrain hexes.

Once placed, a flag stays even after your Squad leaves — the hex remains under your control until an opponent's Squad enters it and re-claims it via the same Phase 2 or Phase 3 step. Contested hexes (both your and an enemy's soldiers on the same hex) skip flag placement until Phase 3 Combat resolves the occupant.

End-of-Round Bonus

Important: This happens at the END OF THE ROUND — after ALL players have completed their turns. It does NOT happen at the end of each individual player's turn.

At the end of each round (after all players have completed their turns), any uncollected resource tokens on your controlled hexes are added to your supply. Additionally, any spaceport hexes you control with container markers grant you the BAC cards from the matching Unloading Zone slot. See the End of Round step in the Turn Structure for full details.

Territory collection is resolved simultaneously for all players once the final player's turn (including Phase 7) is complete.

HOW TO WIN

Three paths lead to victory. The first player to achieve any condition wins immediately — even during another player's turn.

Victory 1: Spaceport Domination

Control the required number of Spaceport Landing Zones:

Players	Spaceports Needed
2	5 of 6
3–4	4 of 6

Your corporate HQ dispatches a full battalion. With the majority of orbital access locked down, rival corporations can no longer resupply — they flee off-world in panic. You win command of the planet.

Victory 2: Military Supremacy

Field 4 full Squads of 7 H.A.M.S each (28 soldiers total) and hold them for 1 full round.

When you reach 28 soldiers, declare Military Supremacy at the end of your turn. If you still have 28 or more soldiers at the start of your next turn, you win. Every opponent gets one full turn to try to knock your numbers down before the victory is confirmed.

Tie: If two or more players both hold 28+ soldiers when checks resolve, the player with the highest Dominance Points (DP) wins. If DP is also tied, continue playing until the tie is broken.

Your overwhelming military presence renders further conflict pointless. Rival HQs withdraw. You are promoted to conquer bigger, richer planets.

Victory 3: Dominance

Accumulate 50 Dominance Points (DP).

DP come from equipped BAC cards — each BAC's DP value counts toward your total as long as the card remains equipped and the soldier carrying it is alive. The local population rallies behind your banner and crowns you their sovereign.

Tracking DP: Count the DP values of all equipment modules currently attached to your living soldiers (check the Equipment Display for each module's DP value). If a soldier dies and their module is destroyed or salvaged by another player, that DP is lost.

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Soldier Equipment Slots

Die Roll	Slot
1	Head
2	Backpack
3	Legs
4–5	Chest
6	Hands

Resource Colors

Resource	Color	Depiction	Hex Tile	Token
Oil	Black	Fuel	Oil Rig	Oil Drum
Electricity	Yellow	Electricity Bolt	Power Plant	Lightning Bolt
Intelligence	Blue	Intel Operator Room	Radar Dish	Transmitting Wave
Industry	Red	Industry Factory	Factory	Hammer
Local Favor	Green	Militia Base	City / Village	Recruit

Turn Phase Summary

#	Phase	Key Action
1	Resource Production	Roll 3d6, place resource tokens on matching hexes
2	Movement	Move each soldier up to 1 hex (or Conspire instead). Squad coherency: stay within 2 hexes of a squadmate
3	Combat	Declare attacks against enemies within 2 hexes (only engaged soldiers roll)
4	Resource Gathering	Collect tokens from occupied/adjacent hexes. Priority: winner -> loser -> active player (if no combat)
5	Purchase & Equip	Buy and equip BACs, recruit soldiers, create Squads
6	Trade	Trade resource tokens freely with other players
7	Move Separatists	Uprising -> consume -> 1 roll moves all -> resolve combats

Key Costs

Action	Cost	Location
Recruit 1 Soldier	1 Local Favor + 1 Oil + 1 Industry + 1 Electricity	City
Create New Squad (min 5)	5× soldier cost	City
Draw from Spaceport Deck	3 same-type resource tokens	Spaceport or City
Conspire	Forfeit 1 Squad's Movement (Phase 2) or Combat (Phase 3)	Anywhere
Untap P.L.A.S.T.E.R	1 Electricity	City or Spaceport
Untap N.I.N.J.A	2 Electricity	City or Spaceport

Combat Quick Reference

Step	Action
Pre	Resolve B.A.S.R (sniper) and S.L.I.M.E (mortar)
1	Both sides roll 1d6 per engaged soldier. Larger side picks best dice
2	Attacker assigns dice to defenders; Defender aligns defense dice
3	Apply equipment bonuses (+attack, +defense)
4	Play Combat Conspire Cards (defender first, then attacker)
5	Attack > Defense = HIT (difference = damage). 4 damage = death -> roll d6 for slot -> salvage
6	Defense beats attack by 3+ = Counterattack (chains: -1 cumulative fatigue)

Victory Conditions

Path	Condition
Spaceport Domination	Control 4 of the 6 Spaceport Landing Zones
Military Supremacy	Field 4 full Squads of 7 H.A.M.S (28 soldiers)
Dominance	Accumulate 50 Dominance Points from equipped BACs

Name your world. Deploy your H.A.M.S. Fight for Dominance.

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